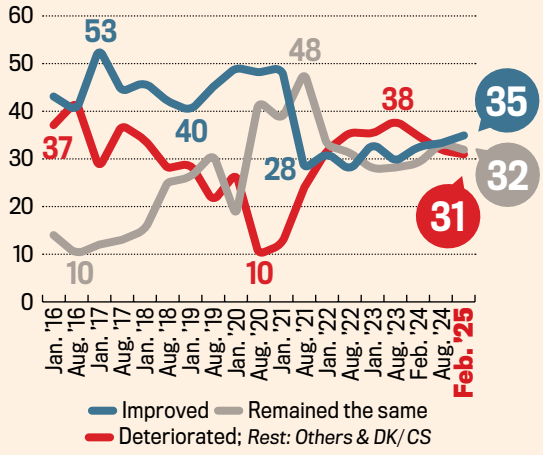
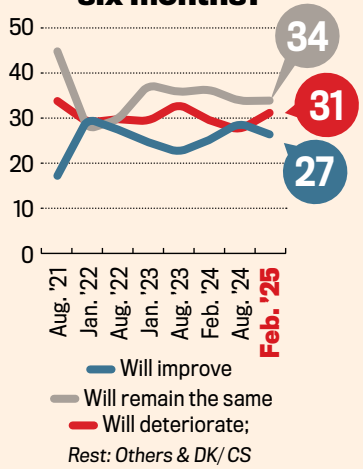
Q. How has your economic status changed since Narendra Modi took charge as prime minister?



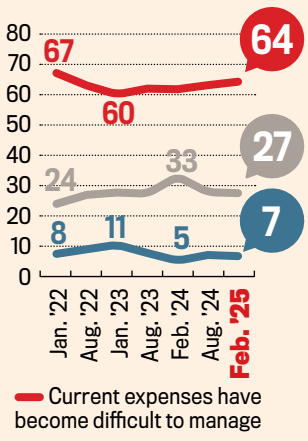
Fewer report improvement in economic status compared to Modi's earlier years in power

Q. Is your household income/ salary likely to improve in the next six months?



Optimism about income recovery declines, while stagnation concerns persist

Q. How do your current daily expenses compare with those last year?



All figures in % and rounded off

70%

of respondents from the lower income group say that current expenses have become difficult to manage, the highest among all income groups

43%

from the higher income group say that the economy will get worse in the next six months, the highest among all income groups

64%

in the Northeast and 60 per cent in the East see the unemployment situation as very serious compared to 48 per cent in the South

cent and 8.5 per cent in the previous survey. The Centre has been extending support to small businesses since the pandemic, providing collateral-free, government-backed loans. In the latest budget, it further revised investment and turnover limits to include more micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and doubled the government-backed loan limit to Rs 10 crore. Meanwhile, the farm sector, which finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman described as the first engine of growth, saw schemes like the PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana, aimed at aiding 17 million farmers across 100 districts with low crop production. The situation for daily-wage earners appears to have improved a notch perceptionally, with 6 per cent of the respondents saying that this group has benefited from government schemes, up from 5 per cent in the previous survey.

Praise for former prime minister Manmohan Singh, who passed away in December 2024, has gone up, with 40 per cent of the respondents saying he managed the economy better, up from 35 per cent in the previous survey. However, a majority—51 per cent—still favour Modi, though this is lower than the 57.4 per cent in August 2024.

In response to a question about whether their economic status has changed since Narendra Modi became PM in 2014, opinions remain mixed, much like in the previous surveys. While 35 per cent of the respondents say it has improved—slightly up from 33.3 per cent in the previous survey—31.8 per cent report no change. The concerning news is that 31 per cent say their economic status has deteriorated. Equally worrying is the outlook on household income or salary over the next six months: 65 per cent believe it will either worsen or remain the same, up from 60.8 per cent in the previous MOTN survey, while only 26.5 per cent expect an improvement.